

Hysteria -- Muse

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From *Absolution* (2003), ~129 BPM.

This is Chris Wolstenholme's signature fuzz-bass riff -- arguably THE bass riff that made his name. Where "Uprising" chased a synth-bass illusion and "Knights of Cydonia" wanted one big controlled drive source, "Hysteria" wants everything: stacked fuzz, sub-octave weight, and a hi-gain amp behind it, gated tight so the riff stays articulate instead of turning to noise. The riff is the whole song -- verse and chorus run at similar intensity, with the chorus pushing a bit harder.

CTL off = the main riff (verse). CTL on = the chorus push.

GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 30
- Always on. High threshold, deliberately -- Wolstenholme's actual rig runs a noise gate for exactly this reason. Stacking fuzz, OD, and a hi-gain amp generates a lot of noise floor; a tight gate is what keeps this riff punchy and articulate instead of washing into mush between notes.

PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 55
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- The riff already hits hard on its own. Chorus gets a clean push to match the song's escalating intensity.

DST -- Bass OD

- Gain: 70, Blend: 75, VOL: 62, Bass: 62, Treble: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- A second drive stage stacked in front of the snaptone's own grit -- this is a deliberately maximalist build, unlike the "one drive source" logic used on cleaner patches. Blend at 75 still keeps enough low end intact that the riff doesn't collapse into fizz.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 58: HairySVT (always on)

- Built from the `SVT SANS HAIRY DRIVE (SVT-CL)` NAM and the Sunn215 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg SVT-CL with the hairy drive setting, into the Sunn215 2x15 IR.
- Wolstenholme's fuzz wall. Hairy SVT drive is the real-bass-amp base under the fuzz and OD.
- Gain: 58, VOL: 55, Bass: 58, Middle: 58, Treble: 55
- Gain 58: noticeably over default. This part wants more push than the other HairySVT patches.
- Bass 58: more low end.
- Middle 58: more midrange.
- Treble 55: a touch more top end.

- VOL 55: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-02 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 58 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +4, 150Hz: -1, 600Hz: +4, 2kHz: +4, 8kHz: +1, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- +4 at 600Hz gives this real midrange snarl and bite -- that's where a lot of this riff's identity lives. 8kHz kept low (+1 only) on purpose -- a triple-stacked gain chain like this already generates plenty of harsh high-frequency harmonics on its own; piling on more top end would just add fizz, not clarity.

MOD -- Off

- No modulation. This is a raw, brute-force riff -- texture would just get in the way of the weight.

DLY -- Off

- Not used.

RVB -- Room -- On CTL

- Mix: 20, Decay: 32, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (verse -- tight and dry, letting the riff hit hard and direct). CTL on: engaged (chorus).
- A touch of room opens things up for the chorus without turning this into a wash -- this song stays heavy and direct even at its biggest moments.

CTL summary

- **CTL Off -- Verse/main riff.** The signature fuzz riff at full weight, dry and direct.
- **CTL On -- Chorus.** Boost and Room reverb engage together for the push through the chorus.
- Engage CTL right as the chorus hits, back off returning to the main riff.

Full pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Engaged

- -OCT: 50
- +OCT: 0
- -2OCT: 0
- +2OCT: 0
- Dry: 75
- Sub-octave only, no upper octave -- this patch wants weight and nastiness, not shimmer. That extra octave-down layer is what turns a merely-distorted bass into the huge, gnarly low end this riff is known for.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged

- COMP: 60
- TONE: 55

- LEVEL: 60
- Mode: TREBLE
- Fairly compressed to keep the aggressive picking pattern tight and consistent going into all that downstream gain. TREBLE mode keeps some attack alive under everything stacked after it.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Engaged

- Sustain: 75
- Treble: 55
- Bass: 60
- Volume: 62
- The pedal that defines this song. Sustain pushed hard for a thick, compressed wall-of-fuzz character -- this is the first of three stacked gain stages (fuzz -> Bass OD -> HairySVT snaptone) that build the full "Hysteria" tone.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged

- Drive: 50
- Blend: 70
- Presence: 60
- Level: 60
- Treble: 55
- Middle: 58
- Bass: 58
- Mid-Frequency: 500Hz
- Bass-Shift: 40Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): Off
- Ground Lift: Off
- The second stacked gain stage. Mid-Frequency at 500Hz and Bass-Shift at 40Hz both push toward body and weight rather than tight articulation -- unlike a punchy garage-rock or boogie tone, this riff wants to feel massive and low, not tight and clicky.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed

- Footswitch off. No chorus -- this is a raw, direct, maximally-gained tone with no room for modulation texture.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.